

User Manual

Automotive Parts Ordering Portal

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This is a sample document prepared for reference and review purposes only. The content should be validated and approved by the appropriate business, legal, compliance, and operational stakeholders before being used as an official policy document.

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1. Introduction

1.1 Parts Search

The parts search area contains a search field where the user can enter a part number or a keyword from the part description. As the user types, the system may suggest matching parts in a dropdown list. The user can select a suggestion or press the search button to see the full list of results. The search results are displayed in a grid below the search field. Each row in the grid represents a part and shows the part number, part description, unit of measure, available stock quantity, and the current price per unit.

If the search returns a large number of results, the user can use the column filters to narrow down the list. For example, the user can filter by part description to find parts matching a specific keyword within the results. The user can also sort the results by clicking on any column header.

When the user finds the correct part, they click on the row to select it. A quantity input field appears, and the user enters the number of units required. If the requested quantity is greater than the available stock, the system displays a message indicating how many units are available immediately and how many would be placed on backlog. The user can choose to proceed with the full quantity, accepting the backlog, or reduce the quantity to the available stock only.

After entering the quantity, the user clicks the add to basket button. The part is added to the order basket and the search area is cleared, ready for the user to search for the next part.

1.2 Order Basket

The order basket displays all parts that have been added to the current order. Each row shows the part number, description, quantity, unit price, and line total. The user can change the quantity of any item in the basket by editing the quantity field directly in the basket. The user can also remove an item from the basket by clicking the remove button on that row. The basket shows a running total of the order value at the bottom.

Once the user has added all required parts, they click the proceed to checkout button. The system performs the credit limit check at this point. If the check passes, the user is taken to the order confirmation screen. If the check fails, a message is displayed explaining the issue and the user remains on the Order Input screen.

1.3 Order Confirmation Screen

The order confirmation screen shows a complete summary of the order including all line items, quantities, prices, the delivery address, and the total order value. The user should review all details carefully before confirming. If any changes are needed, the user can go back to the basket to make corrections. When satisfied, the user clicks the confirm order button. The system submits the order and displays a success message with the order reference number. The user should make a note of this reference number.

Order Tracking Screen

The Order Tracking screen allows users to view the status and details of all orders placed through their account. It is accessible from the main navigation menu.

1.4 Searching for Orders

At the top of the Order Tracking screen there is a search and filter area. The user can search for a specific order by entering the order reference number. Alternatively, the user can filter orders by date range, order status, or part number to find relevant orders without knowing the exact reference number. The search results are displayed in a grid showing the order reference number, order date, total value, current status, and expected delivery date.

1.5 Order Status Meanings

Each order in the tracking grid has a status that indicates where it is in the process. A status of received means the order has been submitted and is waiting to enter the warehouse processing queue. A status of processing means the warehouse team is currently picking the parts for the order. A status of dispatched means the order has been handed to the logistics team and is on its way to the delivery address. A status of delivered means the order has been confirmed as received at the delivery address. A status of partially delivered means some items have been delivered but others are still on backlog. A status of cancelled means the order was cancelled before it was processed.

1.6 Viewing Order Details

The user can click on any order in the grid to open the order detail view. This view shows all line items in the order with their individual statuses, the delivery address, the shipment tracking reference if available, and a history of status changes with timestamps. If the order has been partially delivered, the detail view clearly shows which items have been delivered and which are still outstanding.

1.7 Backlog Items

If an order contains items that could not be fulfilled immediately, these are shown as backlog items in the order detail view. Backlog items have their own expected availability date, which is updated by the warehouse team as information becomes available. The user can monitor backlog items from the order detail view and will receive a notification when a backlog item is dispatched.

Notifications and Alerts

The portal sends notifications to the user when significant events occur related to their orders. These include notifications when an order is dispatched, when a delivery is confirmed, when a backlog item becomes available, and when there are any issues with an order that require the user's attention. Notifications are displayed in the notification area of the portal and may also be sent by email depending on the user's notification preferences.

2. Introduction

2.1 Searching the Parts Catalog

The Parts List screen has a search bar at the top where the user can enter a part number, part description, or keywords. The search is flexible and will return results that match any part of the entered text. For example, searching for the word filter will return all parts whose description contains the word filter. Searching for a specific part number will return that exact part if it exists in the catalog.

The search results are displayed in a grid with columns for part number, description, part category, unit of measure, and availability status. The availability status indicates whether the part is in stock, available on backlog, or discontinued. Parts that have been superseded by a newer version are shown with a superseded indicator, and the replacement part number is displayed alongside.

2.2 Filtering and Sorting Results

The user can apply filters to the search results to narrow down the list. Filters are available for part category, availability status, and price range. Multiple filters can be applied simultaneously. The results can be sorted by any column by clicking the column header. Clicking the same header again reverses the sort order.

2.3 Viewing Part Details

Clicking on a part in the search results opens the part detail panel. This panel shows comprehensive information about the part including the full description, part category, unit of measure, dimensions and weight where available, compatibility information listing the vehicle models and years the part is suitable for, and any technical notes. The part detail panel also shows the current stock level and the price.

If the part has been superseded, the detail panel shows a prominent notice with the replacement part number and a link to view the replacement part's details. Users should always check for superseded parts before ordering to ensure they are ordering the current version.

2.4 Adding Parts to an Order from the Parts List

From the part detail panel, the user can add the part directly to a new or existing order by clicking the add to order button. This opens a small dialog where the user enters the required quantity and confirms. The part is then added to the order basket and the user can continue browsing the catalog.

Parts Locator Screen

The Parts Locator screen allows users to check the availability of a specific part across multiple warehouses or distribution centers. This is useful when a part is not available at the primary warehouse and the user needs to find an alternative source.

2.5 Using the Parts Locator

The user enters a part number in the search field on the Parts Locator screen and clicks search. The system queries all available warehouses and displays the results in a grid. Each row represents a warehouse location and shows the warehouse name, the available quantity at that location, the lead time for delivery from that location, and the applicable price.

The user can use this information to decide where to source the part from. If the part is available at a closer or faster warehouse, the user can select that warehouse as the preferred source when placing the order. If the part is not available at any warehouse, the system will display the expected restocking date if this information is available.

2.6 Interpreting Availability Information

A quantity shown in green indicates that the part is readily available and can be dispatched immediately. A quantity shown in amber indicates limited availability and the user should order promptly to avoid the part going out of stock. A quantity shown in red indicates very low stock, and the user should consider whether to wait for restocking or source the part from an alternative location. A zero quantity with a restocking date indicates that the part is currently out of stock but is expected to be replenished on the shown date.

Price List Screen

The Price List screen allows users to view the current pricing for spare parts. Pricing may vary based on the dealer's contract, the part category, and any active promotions or discounts.

2.7 Viewing Prices

The user can search for a specific part by part number or browse by part category. The price list displays the standard list price and the dealer's net price after any applicable discounts. If the dealer has a special contract price for a particular part, this is shown as the contract price and will be the price applied when the part is ordered.

2.8 Price Validity

Prices displayed in the price list are valid as of the current date. Prices may change periodically in line with supplier cost changes or commercial decisions. The portal displays the date from which the current price is effective. If a price change is scheduled for a future date, the portal may display the upcoming price alongside the current price to allow dealers to plan their purchasing accordingly.

2.9 Currency and Exchange Rates

For dealers operating in multiple currencies, the price list can display prices in the dealer's local currency. The exchange rate used for currency conversion is updated regularly and the current rate is displayed on the price list screen. Dealers should be aware that the exchange rate at the time of invoicing may differ slightly from the rate shown at the time of ordering, as rates are updated periodically.

2.10 Global Price List

The Global Price List screen provides an overview of pricing across all markets and regions. This screen is typically used by administrators and regional managers rather than individual dealers. It allows comparison of prices across different markets and identification of pricing inconsistencies. Access to the Global Price List screen is controlled by user permissions and may not be available to all users.

3. Introduction

3.1 Viewing Active Deliveries

When the user opens the Delivery Status screen, they see a list of all deliveries that are currently in progress. Each row in the list shows the delivery reference number, the associated order reference number, the dispatch date, the expected delivery date, the current delivery status, and the carrier tracking reference where available. The list can be filtered by date range, order reference, or delivery status to help the user find specific deliveries.

3.2 Delivery Status Meanings

A delivery with a status of dispatched has left the warehouse and is in transit to the delivery address. A delivery with a status of out for delivery means the carrier has the shipment on a vehicle and it is expected to be delivered on the current day. A delivery with a status of delivered means the carrier has confirmed delivery at the destination address. A delivery with a status of delivery attempted means the carrier tried to deliver but was unable to, for example because no one was available to receive the shipment. In this case the carrier will typically leave a notification card and the recipient should contact the carrier to arrange redelivery. A delivery with a status of exception means there is an issue with the delivery that requires attention, such as a damaged shipment or an address problem.

3.3 Tracking a Delivery

For deliveries where a carrier tracking reference is available, the user can click the tracking reference link to open the carrier's tracking page in a new browser window. This provides the most up-to-date information directly from the carrier's system. The portal's delivery status is updated periodically based on information received from the carrier, so there may be a short delay between the carrier's system and the portal.

3.4 Confirming Receipt

When a delivery has been received, the user should confirm receipt through the portal. This is done by clicking the confirm receipt button on the delivery detail view. The user is asked to confirm the quantity received for each item in the delivery. If all items have been received in full, the user confirms and the delivery status is updated to delivered. If there are any discrepancies, the user should note them during the receipt confirmation and raise a claim if necessary.

Delivery Backlog Screen

The Delivery Backlog screen shows all order items that could not be fulfilled at the time of the original order and are waiting for stock to become available. It is accessible from the main navigation menu.

3.5 Understanding Backlog Items

A backlog item is created when an ordered part is not available in sufficient quantity at the time the order is processed. Rather than cancelling the unfulfilled portion of the order, the system creates a backlog entry that will be fulfilled as soon as stock becomes available. The Delivery Backlog screen allows the user to monitor all outstanding backlog items and their expected availability dates.

3.6 Managing Backlog Items

Each backlog item in the list shows the original order reference number, the part number and description, the backordered quantity, the date the backlog was created, and the expected availability date. The expected availability date is an estimate based on the warehouse's stock replenishment schedule and may change as circumstances change. The user can click on a backlog item to see more details and to check whether the expected date has been updated.

If a backlog item is no longer needed, for example because the repair has been completed using a part sourced elsewhere, the user can request cancellation of the backlog item by clicking the cancel backlog button. Cancellation requests are subject to approval and the item will remain in the backlog list with a cancellation requested status until the warehouse confirms the cancellation.

HU Monitor Screen

The HU Monitor screen, where HU stands for Handling Unit, provides detailed tracking information for physical packages and pallets associated with the user's orders. It is accessible from the main navigation menu.

3.7 What is a Handling Unit

A handling unit is a physical container, box, or pallet that is used to transport one or more order items. Each handling unit is assigned a unique identifier at the warehouse when the order is packed. A single order may be packed into multiple handling units, and in some cases multiple orders may be consolidated into a single handling unit for efficiency.

3.8 Using the HU Monitor

The HU Monitor screen allows the user to search for a specific handling unit by its identifier, or to view all handling units associated with a specific order reference. The search results show each handling unit with its identifier, the order or orders it is associated with, the contents including part numbers and quantities, the current location in the logistics chain, and the delivery status.

The handling unit detail view shows a complete history of the handling unit's movements, from the moment it was packed at the warehouse through each logistics checkpoint to the final delivery. This level of detail is particularly useful for investigating delivery issues or confirming exactly what was included in a specific shipment.

Billing List Screen

The Billing List screen provides access to all invoices and credit notes associated with the user's account. It is accessible from the main navigation menu.

3.9 Viewing Invoices

The Billing List screen displays a list of all billing documents including invoices for delivered orders and credit notes for approved claims and returns. Each row shows the document number, document type, document date, the associated order or claim reference, and the document value. The list can be filtered by document type, date range, or value to help the user find specific documents.

3.10 Viewing and Downloading Documents

The user can click on any billing document to open the document detail view. This view shows the full details of the invoice or credit note including all line items, quantities, prices, and totals. The user can download the document as a PDF by clicking the download button. Downloaded invoices and credit notes can be used for accounting and record-keeping purposes.

3.11 Invoice Reconciliation

Users are encouraged to regularly reconcile their invoices against their order and delivery records. If an invoice contains items that were not received, or if the quantities or prices on the invoice do not match the delivery, the user should raise a claim through the claim declaration process. Discrepancies should be reported promptly as there are time limits on raising billing disputes.

3.12 Credit Notes

Credit notes are issued when a claim is approved or when a return is processed. A credit note reduces the amount owed by the dealer and is typically applied against the next invoice. The credit note detail view shows the original invoice it relates to, the reason for the credit, and the credit amount. If a credit note has been applied against a specific invoice, this is shown in the credit note details.

4. Introduction

4.1 Selecting the Claim Type

The first step in creating a claim is selecting the claim type from a dropdown list. The available claim types are warranty claim, damage claim, and quantity discrepancy claim. Each claim type has a slightly different form with fields relevant to that type of claim. Selecting the claim type updates the form to show the appropriate fields.

4.2 Entering Order or Delivery Reference

After selecting the claim type, the user enters the order reference number or delivery reference number associated with the parts being claimed. The user types the reference number into the reference field and clicks the lookup button. The system searches for the referenced order or delivery and, if found, displays the parts associated with it in a selection grid below the reference field. If the reference number is not found, the system displays an error message and the user should verify the reference number before trying again.

4.3 Selecting Parts and Quantities

From the parts grid, the user selects the part or parts for which the claim is being raised by clicking the checkbox next to each relevant part. For each selected part, the user enters the quantity being claimed in the claim quantity field. The claim quantity cannot exceed the original purchase or delivery quantity for that part. If the user tries to enter a quantity greater than the original, the system will display a validation error.

4.4 Completing Claim-Specific Fields

For warranty claims, the user must enter the installation date, the failure date, and a detailed description of the failure. The installation date must be on or after the purchase date, and the failure date must be on or after the installation date. The failure description should be as detailed as possible, including any error codes, symptoms, and conditions observed.

For damage claims, the user must enter a description of the damage and upload photographic evidence. The upload button opens a file browser where the user can select image files from their computer. Multiple images can be uploaded. Each uploaded file is shown as a thumbnail in the attachments area of the form.

For quantity discrepancy claims, the user must enter the quantity shown on the delivery note and the quantity actually received for each affected part. The system calculates the discrepancy automatically.

4.5 Submitting the Claim

Once all required fields have been completed, the submit button becomes active. The user clicks submit to send the claim for review. The system validates all fields one final time and, if everything is in order, submits the claim and displays a confirmation screen with the assigned claim reference number. If any validation errors are found, the system highlights the problematic fields and displays error messages explaining what needs to be corrected.

Claim Tracking Screen

The Claim Tracking screen allows users to monitor the status of all claims submitted through their account. It is accessible from the Claims section of the main navigation menu.

4.6 Viewing Claims

The Claim Tracking screen displays a list of all claims associated with the user's account. Each row in the list shows the claim reference number, the claim type, the submission date, the total claimed value, and the current status. The user can filter the list by claim type, status, or date range to find specific claims. Clicking on a claim row opens the claim detail view.

4.7 Claim Detail View

The claim detail view shows all information related to a specific claim. This includes the claim reference number, claim type, submission date, all claimed parts with quantities and values, any attached documents, the current status, and a timeline of status changes. If the claims processing team has added any notes or requests for additional information, these are displayed in the communications section of the detail view.

4.8 Responding to Information Requests

If the claims team requires additional information to process a claim, the claim status will change to awaiting additional information and the user will receive a notification. The user should open the claim detail view and read the request from the claims team. The user can respond by adding a note in the response field and uploading any additional documents requested. After submitting the response, the claim status returns to under review.

4.9 Understanding Claim Statuses

A claim with a status of submitted has been received by the system and is waiting to be assigned to a reviewer. A claim with a status of under review is being actively assessed by the claims processing team. A claim with a status of awaiting additional information requires the user to provide more details before processing can continue. A claim with a status of approved has been accepted and a credit note will be issued. A claim with a status of rejected has not been accepted, and the rejection reason is shown in the claim detail view. A claim with a status of credit issued means the credit note has been generated and applied to the account.

Quarterly Return Screen

The Quarterly Return screen is available during the quarterly return window. It is accessible from the Claims section of the main navigation menu. When the return window is open, the screen displays the window closing date and the maximum returnable value for the current quarter.

The screen shows a list of eligible parts based on the dealer's purchase history from the previous quarter. For each part, the user can enter a return quantity. As quantities are entered, the system updates the total return value and compares it to the maximum allowed. The user submits the return request when all quantities have been entered and the total is within the allowed limit. After submission, the user can download the return authorisation document from the confirmation screen.

Yearly Return Screen

The Yearly Return screen functions in the same way as the Quarterly Return screen but is available during the annual return window. The eligible parts list and maximum returnable value are calculated based on the full year's purchase history. The submission and post-submission process is identical to the quarterly return process.